

Cover Letter

Dear Hiring Manager,

I'm a self-taught software developer with professional experience from 2002 to 2019, progressing from junior roles into a Senior Developer role. My background includes building, maintaining, and improving production systems, collaborating with cross-functional teams, and taking ownership of complex application behavior.

After many years in software, I made a deliberate career change to work as a medical courier in pursuit of a more active, hands-on lifestyle. During that time, I stayed technically engaged through independent software projects and expanded my skill set through aerial photography and commercial drone work as an FAA Part 107–certified Remote Pilot. I'm now intentionally returning to software development with refreshed focus and updated tooling.

Recently, I built a React-based project designed to demonstrate how I approach inherited codebases, focusing on refactoring unclear logic, making UI and loading state explicit, and documenting technical decisions for long-term maintainability. I've also built and maintained multiple real-world websites, balancing usability, structure, and realistic constraints.

I'm comfortable working independently, communicating decisions clearly, and taking ownership of my work. I'm seeking an opportunity to contribute as an experienced developer while continuing to grow with modern tools and teams.

Sincerely,
Chris Rivers

Chris Rivers

Software Developer | Frontend-Focused | Systems, Refactoring & Integration
Remote

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Summary

Senior software developer with extensive experience building, maintaining, and modernizing production systems. Strong background in refactoring legacy code, debugging complex behavior, and improving system clarity and maintainability. Returning to hands-on development with a focus on modern JavaScript, frontend-leaning work, and remote-first teams.

Core Skills

Frontend: JavaScript (ES6+), React (Hooks), HTML, CSS (Responsive UI)

Engineering: State management, debugging, refactoring, CI/CD concepts

Systems: REST APIs, SQL, system integrations, async workflows

Professional Experience

Senior Software Developer – The Seibels Bruce Group

- Built and maintained web applications supporting underwriting, claims, and agent workflows
- Developed full-stack systems spanning UI, backend services, databases, and integrations
- Led redesigns of legacy applications to improve performance and maintainability
- Implemented CI/CD pipelines across development, test, and production environments
- Automated reporting, notifications, and operational workflows
- Diagnosed and resolved production issues in business-critical systems

Programmer / Analyst – Atherotech, Inc.

- Developed web and desktop applications for a clinical laboratory environment
- Built secure data exchange systems for transmitting medical results via VPN and EDI
- Implemented automated distribution systems supporting multiple delivery formats
- Worked within HIPAA compliance and electronic data security requirements

Consultant – U.S. Pipe and Foundry

- Completed development of a transportation and mileage calculation system
- Delivered business-critical functionality under strict time constraints

Technical Support Coordinator / Programmer – Main Street Checks, Inc.

- Provided technical support and training for financial institutions nationwide
- Assisted in development of internal tools and an online reorder system
- Maintained internal systems and web presence

Education

Coursework in Programming, Web Design, and Computer Graphics
Virginia College, Birmingham, AL